London Borough of Camden
Information and Records Management
Judd Street
London.
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e-mail: foi@camden.gov.uk

Date: 28 September 2018

Ref: FOI11767

Dear Requester

Thank you for your request for information dated 06 September 2018 about unauthorised encampments. We have dealt with this under the Environmental Information Regulations 2004 .

Response

The council holds the information requested and the answers to your questions are as follows:

I would like to submit the following questions as part of the FoI legislation:

1. In the last five years (per financial year), how many unauthorised encampments have you had in your borough?

We have not had any unauthorised encampments in the last five years.

a. How many of them have been on public/housing/local authority land?

Please see the response to Q1 above.

b. How many of them have been on private land?

Please see the response to Q1 above.

2. How many times did you have to use powers to remove and evict these encampments (i.e. how many did not leave of their own free will)?

Please see the response to Q1 above.

3. Which eviction and removal powers have you used in the last five years?

Please see the response to Q1 above.

4. How much has it cost the borough in the last five years (per financial year) to deal with unauthorised encampments (such as, but not limited to, clear up, sanitise, legal, officer resource costs, etc).

Please see the response to Q1 above.

5. Do you have a borough-wide injunction (or part-borough) in dealing with unauthorised encampments?

No, we do not have a borough-wide injunction (or part-borough) for dealing with unauthorised encampments.

a. If you don't have an injunction, are you considering one?

No, we are not considering one.

b. If you do, how many times since your injunction have there been unauthorised encampments?

Please see the response to Q5 above.

c. If you do, do you feel that the injunction has been beneficial?

Please see the response to Q5 above.

d. Will you be applying for an extension to the current injunction?

Please see the response to Q5 above.

e. How much did you injunction cost to submit? (officer time, legal costs, research, etc)

Please see the response to Q5 above.

6. Would be grateful if you could forward me your injunction information/details.

Please see the response to Q5 above.

a. Did you use in-house or external legal services?

Please see the response to Q5 above.

b. If external, whom did you use?

Please see the response to Q5 above.

7. How many legal traveller sites do you have? (Please provide a list)

The Council owns and manages two legal traveller sites, these are at:

- Castlehaven Road
- Camden Street (corner of Carol Street) NW1

There is also a privately owned travelling show-people's yard at the Vale of Health NW3.

a. In total, how many pitches are there?

There are 5 pitches on Council owned traveller sites.

b. What is the average occupancy rate at these sites/pitches?

The average occupancy rate is 100%.

c. As of today, how many pitches are occupied?

100% of the pitches are occupied.

d. As of today, how many pitches are vacant?

No pitches are vacant.

e. What are the pitch fees?

The pitch fees are £46.24 per week.

f. Do the pitches have facilities such as water, electricity/gas, waste and recycling facilities, other? (Yes/No to each of those categories)

Water: Yes

Electricity: Yes

Gas: No

Waste and recycling: Yes

g. What does your development/housing/assessment needs plan (or such like), in the last ten years or so, state as to what the required number of pitches is to meet needs?

The Camden Local Plan 2016 indicates that seven additional pitches are needed by 2020/21 and a further nine additional pitches are needed by 2031/31.

8. Do you have any legal transit sites in your borough?

No, we do not have any legal transit sites.

a. If so, how many? (details please)

Please see the response to Q8 above.

b. Are they permanent or temporary sites?

Please see the response to Q8 above.

c. Are they being used?

Please see the response to Q8 above.

9. Do you have a specific traveller and gypsy liaison officer(s)? (Please provide details)

No, we do not have specific traveller and gypsy liaison officers.

a. Full-time or part-time?

Please see the response to Q9 above.

b. Since when did you have this post(s)?

Please see the response to Q8 above.

c. If you don't have a specific officer are you intending to recruit for one?

No, we are not intending to recruit one.

10. Is the council considering other actions to minimise unauthorised encampments?

Please see the response to Q1 above.

11. Did the council respond to the government consultation earlier this year? (https://www.gov.uk/government/consultations/powers-for-dealing-with-unauthorised-development-and-encampments)

The Council did not respond to this consultation.

a. Please forward me the submission

Please see the response to Q11 above.

Further Information:

Why not check our Portal Open Data Camden before making a new request as your question may already be answered by a previous FOI response or in one of our many useful and interesting datasets.

Your Rights

If you are not happy with how your response was handled you can request an Internal Review within 2 months of this letter by email to foireviews@camden.gov.uk or post: Information and Records Management Team, London Borough of Camden, Town Hall, Judd Street, London WC1H 9JE. Please quote your case reference number.

If you are not satisfied with the Internal Review outcome you can complain to the Information Commissioner's Office at casework@ico.org.uk

Telephone 0303 123 1113, or post to:

Information Commissioner's Office
Wycliffe House
Water Lane

Wilmslow
Cheshire
SK9 5AF

The ICO website www.ico.org.uk may be useful.

Yours sincerely

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